

One who has a negative reputation	notorious
A medicine that induces sleep	narcotic
A place where plants are reared	nursery
Something which is no longer in use	obsolete
Through which we cannot see	opaque
One who is eighty years old	octogenarian
One who looks at the bright side of things	optimist
One who knows everything	omniscient
One who is present everywhere	omnipresent
One who is all powerful	omnipotent
One who acts according to situation to get advantage	opportunist
Holding established traditional opinion	orthodox
A cure for all diseases	panacea
Who lives on others	parasite
Lover of wife/husband	paramour
Killer of father	patricide
One who looks at the dark side of things	pessimist
Killer of pests	pesticide
One who loves mankind	philanthropist
Representation of speech sounds through symbols	phonetic
One who walks on foot	pedestrian
Chief person in a drama or story	protagonist
The study of human mind	psychology
Sole right to sell some invention	patent
A room where food is kept for serving	pantry
Having more than two wives/husbands	polygamy
One who is liked by everybody	popular
Where ships are loaded or unloaded	port
Generation that comes after	progeny
One who withdraws from society to live a solitary life	recluse
One who sees life as it is	realist
A place for improving one's health	resort
Too much official formality	red tapism
Simple, artless country people	rustic

Study of the meanings of words	semantics
One who is indifferent to pain and pleasure	stoic
Killing oneself	suicide
A person who honours all religions	secular
One who spends too much	spendthrift
A religious discourse	sermon
One who doubts the validity of every statement	sceptic
Words having more or less same meanings	synonyms
Taking place at the same time	simultaneous
One who speaks for a party	spokesman
One who takes the place of	surrogate
Table newspaper half the size of normal newspaper	tabloid
A storm when violent winds move in circles	tornado
One who believes in God	theist
An object through which light passes and one can see through it	transparent
An object through which some light passes but one cannot see through it	translucent
Lasting for short time	transient
One who abstains from all alcoholic drinks	teetotaler
That which is agreed upon by all	unanimous
An imaginary ideal	utopia
Word for word	verbatim
One who can think and plan about the future with imagination and intelligence	visionary
One who changes easily from one mood to another	volatile
One who offers one's services without asking	volunteer
One who is gifted with several talents	versatile
One who can be easily hurt	vulnerable
Strong fear of people from other countries	xenophobia
A part of directory which contains information about traders, professionals etc.	yellow pages

possible; probable	It is possible to check corruption but it does not look probable in India when the Ministers themselves are corrupt.
remember; recollect	I remember telephone numbers of my friends but often fail to recollect the one I need.
sensitive; sensible	He is a sensible man so you can expect him to be sensitive to your loss.
urban; urbane	We can call him urban because he lives in Karnal but he is not urbane; he lacks polished behaviour.
understand; comprehend	I can understand Punjabi but I doubt if I can comprehend the spirit of this Amrita Pritam poem.
value; price	I value this book because it has changed my life. Its high price does not matter.
warm; warmly	The weather was warm in the evening yet she received me warmly.

Compound Words

Compound words are formed by combining two or more basic words. The compound word is treated as a unit.

For example

class	+	room	=	classroom
air	+	lines	=	airlines
camera	+	man	=	cameraman
washer	+	man	=	washerman

One word substitution

Brevity is a quality in communication. It can be achieved by using a single word which shall convey the meaning conveyed by a group of words. In other words, a single word can replace a part/whole of a sentence.

Important Substitutes

A written declaration on oath	affidavit
A creature from a different land	alien
List of things to be discussed in a meeting	agenda
One who does not believe in God	atheist
A medicine used for preventing infection by killing the germs	antiseptic
A medicine used to counter the effect of another	antidote
Belonging to one's ancestors	ancestral
The stage of growth between boyhood and youth	adolescent
The right of self governance	autonomy
Animals that live in water	aquatic
Sound which can be heard	audible
One who is out to destroy all government and order	anarchist
The life history of a man written by himself	autobiography
One who pursues something not for money but for pleasure	amateur
When the name of the author is not known	anonymous
A person who makes a study of mankind	anthropologist
A person leading a life of austerity	ascetic
Large heavy guns moved on wheels	artillery
The study of planets	astronomy
Persons having very modern ideas in music, art and literature	avant-garde
A scientific study of body	anatomy
Words having opposite meanings	antonyms
A place that provides refuge	asylum
To increase the speed	accelerate
The yearly return of a date	anniversary
That happens every year	annual
The absence of government in a country	anarchy
A place where beer is manufactured	brewery
One who is unable to pay off one's debts	bankrupt

Word	Meaning	Usage
human	natural to mankind	It is human to be jealous of others success.
humane	kind	Prisoners of Iraq war were not accorded a humane treatment.
industrial	relating to industry	There is no clarity in the industrial policy of UPA Government.
industrious	hard working	He is industrious so he is sure to succeed in life.
judicial	pertaining to law	This is my last verdict in my judicial capacity.
judicious	wise	We should be judicious in choosing our friends.
luxuriant	rich in growth	She had a luxuriant growth of hair.
luxurious	full of luxury	With a lac every month he is leading a luxurious life.
negligent	careless	Any one found negligent will be punished.
negligible	very little	There is a negligible rise in the profits of BHEL.
official	connected with the office	The C.E.O. has gone on an official tour of Japan.
officious	meddlesome	His officious manners have made him unpopular in the office.
practical	opposed to theoretical	One has to face practical problems in life.
practicable	that which can be translated into action	I doubt if your plan is practicable.
precede	to go before	Nationalism should precede every thing else.

Word	Meaning	Usage
proceed	to go on	The selection committee is proceeding to Bangalore tomorrow.
social	of society	Marriage is a social requirement.
sociable	fit for company	You cannot be sociable if you are not likable.

Words often confused, used in the same sentence

admit; confess	I admit that I visited Agra but I cannot confess to the theft that took place there.
behaviour; conduct	Her overall conduct is good but her behaviour is often not up to the mark.
begin; start	He began his profession as a doctor and started going to the hospital last Monday.
cause; reason	The cause of the trouble is that her husband does not give reasons for his coming late every evening.
contentment; satisfaction	Items of luxury can give us satisfaction but contentment comes only when we are happy from within.
correct; accurate	Some times even if the method is not correct we get accurate results.
deny; refuse	All those who deny the existence of God refuse to visit temples.
empty; vacant	The building is vacant but its not empty. Nobody lives there but the furniture is there.
house; home	We have a big house but there is nothing like home there; we live together but have no feelings for each other.
hire; rent	Having rented out the house, he hired a taxi and returned home.
people; person	All the people were requested to put their demands but only four persons came forward.

lightning	lightening
luxurious	luxuriant
officer	official, officious
practical	practicable
proportionate	proportional
social	sociable, societal
unity	union, unison

Words often confused with one another

Word	Meaning	Usage
able	competent	He is not yet able to come to office.
capable	capacity to do	She is not capable of lecturing for three hours.
accident	tragic	The train accident took a heavy toll of life.
incident	a minor event/happening	The air hostess narrated some interesting incidents of her first flight.
advance	money paid before	The carpenter asked for an advance with the order for table.
advances	attempts to start a sexual relationship	Lady secretary welcomed the advances made by her boss.
advancement	work done for furthering knowledge	Internet helped me in making advancement in my research.
ancient	not modern	Religion was a part of life in the ancient times.
old	not new	Old women talk too much.
allow	not to refuse	You are allowed to go.
permit	give consent	He was permitted to take the test.

Word	Meaning	Usage
apprise	to inform	The principal has been apprised of the matter.
appraise	to judge	It is impossible to appraise the work of teachers by the reports collected from students.
conscience	sense of right or wrong	My conscience pricks when I cheat anybody.
conscious	aware	I am not conscious of anything undesirable being done in my office.
childish	negative sense	His actions are childish even at 20.
childlike	positive sense	Sania Mirza has a childlike expression.
credible	believable	Her story is hardly credible.
creditable	worthy	His performance in sports is creditable.
deny	a statement	How can you deny having received gifts from me?
refuse	a thing	The boy was refused admission.
elicit	to draw out	The police failed to elicit any information from the terrorist.
illicit	unlawful	He was arrested for illicit sale of alcohol.
honorary	holding office without pay	Mansi is the honorary secretary of our society.
honourable	worthy of honour	Many honourable Members of Parliament were present at the function.

Homophones	Meaning	Usage
rights	privileges	We demand our rights but forget our duties.
rites	ceremony	The funeral rites were performed yesterday.
writes	to write	Ruskin Bond writes interesting short stories.
route	way	The bus route has been changed.
root	part of plant	The root absorbs the water and nutrients from the soil.
roll	to tumble	If the driver fails to slow down, the bus might roll into a khud.
role	part	I shall play the role of a villain in the film.
story	tale	The story you wrote has been appreciated.
storey	floor	We are staying in a two-storey house.
stair	steps	Always take the stairs to keep yourself healthy.
stare	stern look	His foolish joke invited a stare from his father.
soul	spirit	This music has a soul.
sole	bottom of shoe	The sole of your shoes is not suitable for trekking.
sale	to sell	Is this house on sale?
sail	to travel by water	We shall sail to the Andamans next month.
stationary	still	The car banged into a stationary bus.
stationery	writing material	A good writer is not bothered about his stationery.

Homophones	Meaning	Usage
vocation	work one likes	Teaching is not a profession, its a vocation.
vacation	holidays	I shall go to Goa during winter vacation.
weigh	to measure	Let us weigh the gas cylinder before we pay for it.
way	course	The doctor is on the way.
rest	to relax	Let us rest awhile before we start again.
wrest	to snatch	Let us wrest control of the firm.
weak	infirm	The weak shall inherit the kingdom of heaven.
week	seven days	In a week from now, I shall be in Goa.
yoke	forcibly join	To marry is not to yoke two lives together.
yolk	Yellow of an egg	Egg-yolk is a rich source of cholesterol.

Paronyms

Paronyms are words derived from the same root but different in meaning. The root part of the word has resemblance of spelling and sound.

Illustration

admittance (admit + ance)	admission (adm + ission)
childish (child + ish)	childlike (child + like)
alternate	alternative
beneficent	beneficial
considerate	considerable
comprehensive	comprehensible
judicial	judicious

Homophones	Meaning	Usage
lone	lonely	I was the lone commuter on the bus.
mansion	building	She lives in a mansion at beach.
mention	to speak	I promise not to mention it again.
meat	flesh	Meat is a good source of animal protein.
meet	to see	Let us meet at the PVR.
marry	to wed	When are you going to marry?
merry	happy	Let us make merry while we are unmarried.
metal	substance with at metallic lustre	The metal-detector is installed at the entry of public offices.
mettle	courage	Adversity tests one's mettle.
medal	in honour	He was awarded a medal for his bravery.
meddle	to interfere	Please tell your friend not to meddle in my affairs.
neighbour	living next door	My neighbour is good at borrowing sugar from my household.
never	not ever	Never waste water, for it is in short supply.
naughty	mischievous	Children should be allowed to be naughty.
knotty	complicated	Saving his job will be a knotty problem.
one	number	One fine morning, I decided to change.

Homophones	Meaning	Usage
won	victory	We won the match comfortably.
our	that belongs to us	Friends are our lifeboats, they cheer us when we are down.
hour	time	Let us meet after an hour.
pray	prayer	I pray before I sleep, every night.
prey	hunted	The tiger preys on the deer.
petrol	fuel	The price of petrol escalates every six months.
patrol	surveillance	The guard shall patrol the colony at night.
principal	head of institution	The principal was happy at the trophy our team won for the institution.
principle	ideology	It is my principle not to accept a favour.
peace	tranquillity	I am at peace with myself.
piece	part	Let me have a piece of cake.
personal	private	My personal life is none of your business.
personnel	staff	The security personnel were smartly attired.
quite	altogether	I'm quite sure I saw the man today.
quiet	silence	I like to have a quiet holiday.
rain	shower	Incessant rain can disrupt rail and road traffic.
reign	rule	During the reign of Akbar, the arts flourished.

Homophones	Meaning	Usage
hair	body-hair	My hair are my crowning glory.
hare	animal	I saw him running like a hare.
heel	part of foot	A high heel shoe can damage your spine.
heal	cure	Music can heal the soul.
incite	provoke	Why did you incite him to fight?
insight	deep understanding	I had an insight into his character when I saw him fighting with his wife over money.
idle	lazy	Why do you sit idle when so much needs to be done?
idol	image	Krishna's idol at the <i>Bihari-ji</i> temple is beautiful.
jeans	trousers	My blue denim jeans are my favourite.
genes	genetic	Scientists have isolated the genes responsible for irresponsible behaviour.
kettle	a vessel	Put the kettle on the boil if you need tea.
cattle	animals	A <i>Gujjar</i> is known by the cattle he owns.
knew	past tense of know	I knew that if I worked hard, there was nothing beyond my reach.
new	fresh	One should look for new goals and challenges in life.
know	knowledge	I know that I can do it.

Homophones	Meaning	Usage
no	negative	No amount of criticism can shake my determination.
letter	a mode of communication	Please write a letter every week to inform us of your well-being.
later	After some time	Don't reach later than five, for the entry shall not be open beyond that time.
latter	coming after	The latter order batsmen failed to score in the match.
lose	miss	Our team might lose if we don't play to a plan.
loose	not tight	My trousers are loose, and need a belt.
lion	animal	<i>Gir</i> is the last habitat of the Asiatic lion.
loin	junction of stomach and legs	The men were wearing nothing but for a loin-cloth.
lather	foam	I need a shampoo that gives good lather.
leather	tanned hide	Leather bags are always in vogue.
✓ lesson	moral	The lesson I learnt was worth the effort I took.
lessen	reduce	Having a <i>paracetamol</i> will lessen the pain.
lightening	to reduce	Gadgets help us in lightening our work.
lightning	a flash of light	The violent storm with thunder and lightning killed 5 men.
loan	debt	I can give my computer on loan for a week.

Homophones	Meaning	Usage
dessert	fruit-dish after dinner	Can I have some Alphonso for dessert tonight?
dose	prescribed quantum of medicine	Have you taken the morning dose of your medicine?
doze	sleep, nap	If you keep singing, I will doze off.
descent	downward slope	The descent from the mountain is more dangerous as compared to the ascent.
dissent	disagreement	There is a lot of dissent to the plan of disinvestment in the Navratna PSUs.
device	noun	The police recovered the explosive device in time.
devise	verb	The citizens need to devise mechanisms to counter terrorism.
✓ emigrant	one who leaves his country to live in another	The emigrant film-makers are making the best films in Britain these days.
immigrant	people living in a foreign country	Immigrants face a lot of problems whenever there is a terrorist strike in London.
✓ elicit	draw out	We failed to elicit a response from the management.
illicit	unlawful	An illicit relationship always causes trouble.
eligible	fit	He is the most eligible candidate for the job.
illegible	unreadable	His illegible entrance test paper ruined his chances.

Homophones	Meaning	Usage
feign	act	I feign that I'm busy when boring people call up.
✓ fain	gladly	I would fain have enrolled for the army.
fair	honest	Let us use fair means to defeat the other team.
fare	payment for journey	I did not have bus fare, so I had to walk down.
farm	field	I want to start an organic farm.
form	printed application	Please download the admission form from the net.
feet	body-part	My feet ache when I wear tight shoes.
feat	achievement	It is no mean feat to be an astronaut.
fate	destiny	The court will decide our fate today.
fete	festival	I took my son to his school fete.
flour	powdered grain	Doctors recommend the use of whole-wheat flour.
flower	blossom	A flower looks best on its stem.
✓ gait gait	manner of walking	He has a graceful gait.
gate	entrance	We keep the front gate open till nine in the night.
1 gild gild	past participle of gild	He has a gilt edged sword.
✓ guilt	sense of having done wrong	His guilt weighs heavy on his conscience.

Homophones	Meaning	Usage
cite	to quote	The lawyer could cite many judgements in support of his arguments.
site	location	The site of the slum falls next to a school.
sight	vision	The sight of land gave immense joy to the sailor.
compliment	praise	Did you compliment your teacher for his new book.
complement	something that completes	A good husband complements his wife.
conscience	sense of right and wrong	My conscience pricks me when I know the truth and yet do not come forward.
conscious	aware	I am conscious of my duties as a citizen.
council	committee	The council decided to reward the workers.
counsel	advice	When in trouble, what one needs most is sane counsel.
canvas	coarse fabric	M.F. Hussein uses oil on canvas for his painting.
canvass	solicit support	The film stars line up to canvass for the politicians.
cell	chamber	The cell in which Mahatma Gandhi was kept has been declared a heritage monument.
sell	dispose off	I had no option but to sell the motorcycle.
cease	stop	The Prime Minister declared a cease-fire.

Homophones	Meaning	Usage
seize ^a	capture	He seized the opportunity and renounced violence.
course	syllabus	The course has been completed well in time.
coarse	rough	He bought some coarse fabric for the curtains.
cereal	of grain	Wheat, barley and millets are all cereals.
serial	in instalments	Terrorists go in for serial blasts to create panic among people.
carrier	vehicle	Even when a person does not have full-blown AIDS, he can be a carrier of the HIV infection.
career	prospects in profession ^a	My career prospects brightened when I polished my communication skills.
decease	death	Police usually under reports the deceased in a riot.
disease	sickness	The best way to keep disease at bay is to eat healthy food and to do exercise.
dependant	one who depends on others for sustenance	Though not related, 15-year old Sujata is a dependant on us.
dependent	relying upon	The festival is heavily dependent on sponsorship for its success.
desert	a sandy wasteland	The Thar desert provides a foil to the colourful people of Rajasthan.

Homophones	Meaning	Usage
access	approach	Do you have access to the principal of the college?
excess	too much	Excess of smoking and drinking damages lungs.
accede	consent	He did not accede to my request.
exceed	surpass	You exceed my expectations.
accept	admit, receive	Please accept my apology.
except	excluding	Every body except me had a cola.
ascent	going up	The ascent to the Everest will test one's nerves.
accent	way of pronunciation	My call-centre friends have picked up an American accent.
assent	consent	I gave my assent to a dowry-less marriage.
addition	adding more	Browsing the dictionary shall help me make an addition to my vocabulary.
edition	version of publication	The latest edition of this book is well illustrated.
bale	a large packet	The waste paper is baled and then sent for recycling.
bail	guarantee money for an accused	She was realeased on Rs 50,000 bail.
birth	to be born	Blessed are those that celebrate the birth of their daughters.
berth	seat	I got a berth in the Rajdhani Express with difficulty.

Homophones	Meaning	Usage
beside	by the side of	Daughters love sitting beside their father.
besides	in addition to	I gave the blind school one computer besides my monthly donation.
borne	carried	The burden of shifting has to be borne by me.
born	given birth	I was born at Rohtak.
break	damage	If I fall, I'll break my neck.
brake	check	If my brakes work, I can avoid a collision.
bridal	adjective of bride	A Rohit Bal designed bridal lehanga may cost Rs 10 lacs.
bridle	to control	Discipline is needed to bridle one's imaginative flights.
check	examine	I need to check your papers.
cheque	bank instrument	If your cheque is dishonoured, you can be jailed.
cast	throw	He cast a glance at his watch and hurried away.
cost	price	What is the cost of your T.V.?
caste	a social classification	The caste system – earlier based on distribution of work, is now based on birth.
ceiling	roof	The ceiling leaks after the rains.
sealing	putting seal	I need some glue for the sealing of this letter.

tax	noun	Pay your tax by the due date.
	verb	Don't tax your mind for nothing.
test	noun	The test given in the class was simple.
	verb	Test your feelings yourself.
use	noun	The computer is put to various uses.
	verb	Use your mobile only in an emergency.
venture	noun	There seems to be money in this venture.
	verb	Don't venture out in the night.
vote	noun	Cast your vote for the right person.
	verb	You are requested to vote for the motion.

Unsolved Exercise

Use each of the following words in two separate sentences, first as noun and then as verb:

stand	field	chair	sense	notice	sacrifice
quarrel	book	hand	yield	lock	water
grant	process	object	summon	fan	move
corner	man	trade	volunteer	pocket	face

Homophones

Homophone is a word that sounds like another word but is different in spelling, meaning and origin. 'Knew' and 'new' are homophones (of each other).

Homophones are sound-alikes, so when it comes to writing, their spellings confuse us and it results in mistakes. The following examples will illustrate:

Homophones	Meaning	Usage
advice (n)	counsel	My advice to you is to believe in yourself.
advise (v)	counsel	I can only advise, I cannot force you to change.

Homophones	Meaning	Usage
adapt	adjust	It took me an hour to adapt to the cold weather.
adept	skilled	He is adept at using the camera.
adopt	to take up	Don't adopt unfair means to pass. I plan to adopt a young girl.
adverse	unpleasant	After my father's death I passed through adverse circumstances.
averse	not opposed to	I am not averse to your idea of shifting to Noida.
altar	raised platform in church	The altar is the most pious place in a Church.
alter	to make different	I asked my tailor to alter my coat to current style.
air	wind	Use of ill-maintained vehicles adds to air pollution.
heir	inheritor	Sonia is political heir of Indra Gandhi.
affect (v)	to produce material effect	The Buddha's sermon affected Angulimala and he became a saint.
effect (n)	result	The effect of the sermon was permanent.
effect (v)	to produce	I have effected the necessary changes in my lifestyle in to fight stress.
aloud	said loud	Did he read my letter aloud in the class?
allowed	permitted	Who allowed him to read my letter?

gesture	noun	As a gesture of goodwill he donated his eyes.
	verb	Gesture him to wait for a while.
glance	noun	A glance is enough to understand everything.
	verb	Glance at your watch please.
hand	noun	Sania Mirza plays with her left hand.
	verb	Hand over this file to your teacher.
handle	noun	The handle grip of the motorcycle is loose.
	verb	Handle this packet with care.
inch	noun	We no more measure in inches.
	verb	The soldiers had to inch towards the border.
issue	noun	It is a minor issue. So don't make a fuss over it.
	verb	Issue a warning to the players.
jerk	noun	Even a little jerk caused pain in her ankle.
	verb	The car jerked to a stop.
knock	noun	I heard a knock at the door.
	verb	The boxer couldn't knock down his opponent.
laugh	noun	Some people can laugh at any joke.
	verb	It is advisable to laugh out your blues.
leave	noun	I have applied for leave from the college.
	verb	Leave the room at once.
matter	noun	Your matter in this essay is good.
	verb	Your absence from the office will matter.
mind	noun	Your mind is not in the studies.
	verb	Mind your own business. Why pester me?
match	noun	A T-20 cricket match is full of excitement.
	verb	Match your ability with others.

need	noun	Modern parents look after the needs of children.
	verb	We need a receptionist.
notice	noun	A notice was given to the students to disperse.
	verb	We can notice the change in her behaviour.
part	noun	She played her part very well in the drama.
	verb	If you can't adjust then it is better for us to part ways.
pay	noun	We receive our pay regularly.
	verb	Pay the bills and buzz off.
plot	noun	This plot of land is for sale.
	verb	Plot the graph again.
question	noun	The question in the paper was easy.
	verb	The police can question anybody.
record	noun	The record is meticulously kept in courts.
	verb	Police can record your statement anywhere.
rush	noun	There is a mad rush at malls.
	verb	Rush the accident victim to the hospital.
reserve	noun	There are five players in reserve.
	verb	Reserve your seats in advance.
stress	noun	There is much stress in life these days.
	verb	You must stress your point in the interview.
sound	noun	I love high pitched sound.
	verb	Her explanation sounds reasonable to me.
taste	noun	You have a refined taste.
	verb	Taste this dish; my mother has cooked it for you.

act	noun	The government has passed a new act.
	verb	We must not act in haste.
admire	noun	I am all admiration for Sehwag's stroke making.
	verb	I admire the way she handles her husband.
air	noun	Air is a mixture of many gases.
	verb	We always air our views about our Boss.
arm	noun	He has injured his arm.
	verb	The training shall arm you to face any eventuality in life.
bank	noun	Money is safe if kept in a bank.
	verb	Don't bank upon him. He is not dependable.
bar	noun	The Delhi government is open to the idea of beer-bars.
	verb	The police had to bar the entry of the public after the riots.
bend	noun	There is a bend in the river at Okhla.
	verb	Politicians bend the rules whenever they want.
cable	noun	The workers have laid down the new cable.
	verb	Please cable me the message as soon as you reach New York.
call	noun	The students want to receive their calls even in the classroom.
	verb	You need not call upon me in future.
care	noun	Good care needs to be taken of your spectacles.
	verb	Parents care for their children.
chair	noun	Kindly take your chair.
	verb	She was requested to chair the meeting.

chalk	noun	The chalks are no more in use in college.
	verb	It is advisable to chalk out your plan.
cheat	noun	He is a well-known cheat.
	verb	Don't cheat your friends.
conduct	noun	The officer's conduct is suspect.
	verb	Conduct yourself with confidence.
damage	noun	The flood caused much damage in Patna.
	verb	Do nothing to damage your reputation.
debate	noun	We have to participate in a debate competition.
	verb	In Parliament we debate every issue.
demand	noun	Black & White TV is no more in demand.
	verb	The principal can demand your identity card anytime.
design	noun	Everyday a new design of shirt is in the market.
	verb	You can design your home yourself.
echo	noun	An echo is heard when we shout in a well.
	verb	Do not echo the words of your mother.
excuse	noun	Your excuses will have no effect on me.
	verb	Excuse me for coming late.
express	noun	The express trains run fast.
	verb	Express your feelings without any fear.
fashion	noun	Fashion changes everyday.
	verb	Fashion your shirt yourself.
fear	noun	Your fear is unfounded.
	verb	Children fear the ghost.
feel	noun	You can have a feel of the smooth surface.
	verb	The doctors feel the pulse of patients.
figure	noun	Models have perfect figure and poise.
	verb	Since morning he is trying to figure out his loss.

15. Nouns formed by adding '-acy/cy'

private	privacy	accurate	accuracy
secret	secrecy	vacant	vacancy
diplomat	diplomacy	bureaucrat	bureaucracy

16. Miscellaneous

advise	advice	bear	birth
behave	behaviour	believe	belief
bind	bond	choose	choice
feed	food	exceed	excess
hate	hatred	know	knowledge
learn	learning	laugh	laughter
receive	receipt	respond	response
sit	seat	strive	strife

C. VERBS**1. Verbs formed by adding '-en'**

hard	harden	soft	soften
length	lengthen	strength	strengthen
deep	deepen	loose	loosen
short	shorten	thick	thicken

2. Verbs formed by adding '-fy' / '-ify'

pure	purify	terror	terrify
beauty	beautify	intense	intensify
pace	pacify	identity	identify
horror	horrify	just	justify
class	classify	simple	simplify
example	exemplify	certain	certify

3. Verbs formed by adding '-ise'

tranquil	tranquillise	sympathy	sympathise
pressure	pressurise	equal	equalise
familiar	familiarise	apology	apologise

special	specialise	commercial	commercialise
centre	centralise	memory	memorize
local	localise	critic	criticise

4. Verbs formed by adding '-ate'

origin	originate	table	tabulate
humble	humiliate	motive	motivate
office	officiate	term	terminate

5. Verbs formed by adding '-en/im/em'

circle	encircle	camp	encamp
cage	encage	bitter	embitter
power	empower	body	embody
prison	imprison	peril	imperil
bitter	embitter	danger	endanger

6. Verbs formed by adding '-de/dis':

mean	demean	face	deface
cry	decry	fame	defame
figure	disfigure	throne	dethrone

Homonyms

Homonym is a word that has the same sound and same spelling as another but is different in meaning or origin. The noun "bear" and the verb "bear" are homonyms (of each other).

A homonym can be used as different parts of speech.

A list of homonyms in common use is given below:

abuse	noun	He hurled the choicest abuses at me.
	verb	Politicians abuse their power.
ache	noun	I have severe headache since morning.
	verb	My heart aches to see her plight.

young	youth	hot	heat
weigh	weight	see	sight

6. Nouns formed by adding '-er/ar/or'

govern	governor	donate	donor
school	scholar	war	warrior
visit	visitor	sing	singer
lead	leader	office	officer

7. Nouns formed by adding '-ist/ian'

magic	magician	politics	politician
electric	electrician	mathematics	mathematician
history	historian	physics	physician
	motor	motorist	cycle cyclist
art	artist	science	scientist
tour	tourist	cartoon	cartoonist

8. Nouns formed by adding '-ee/er'

employ	employee	refuge	refugee
absent	absentee	mountain	mountaineer
engine	engineer	racket	racketeer

9. Nouns formed by adding '-ment'

enjoy	enjoyment	amuse	amusement
pay	payment	confine	confinement
fulfil	fulfilment	resent	resentment
commit	commitment	improve	improvement
arrange	arrangement	manage	management

10. Nouns formed by adding '-tion/sion'

admit	admission	solve	solution
decide	decision	extend	extension
revise	revision	permit	permission
separate	separation	inform	information
combine	combination	select	selection

cancel	cancellation	reveal	revelation
terminate	termination	germinate	germination

11. Nouns formed by adding '-ance/ ence'

enter	entrance	excel	excellence
assure	assurance	defy	defiance
obey	obedience	pretend	pretence
exit	existence	repent	repentance
rely	reliance	reside	residence
confide	confidence	assist	assistance
resist	resistance	appear	appearance
endure	endurance	occur	occurrence

12. Nouns formed by adding '-ial/al'

deny	denial	bury	burial
refuse	refusal	try	trial
approve	approval	dismiss	dismissal
propose	proposal	arrive	arrival
renew	renewal	betray	betrayal
reverse	reversal	form	Formal

13. Nouns formed by adding '-age'

carry	carriage	store	storage
post	postage	use	usage
waste	wastage	break	breakage
leak	leakage	marry	marriage
pass	passage	post	postage

14. Nouns formed by adding '-ity/ ty'

poor	poverty	pure	purity
scare	scarcity	curious	curiosity
vain	vanity	local	locality
necessary	necessity	able	ability
generous	generosity	moral	morality
honest	honesty	total	totality

6. Adjectives formed by adding '-worthy'

praise	praiseworthy	trust	trustworthy
note	noteworthy	air	airworthy

7. Adjectives formed by adding '-able/ible'

avoid	avoidable	advise	advisable
memory	memorable	admire	admirable
consider	considerable	bear	bearable
reverse	reversible	sense	sensible
convert	convertible		

8. Adjectives formed by adding '-ous'

religion	religious	space	spacious
advantage	advantageous	vigour	vigorous
vice	vicious	office	officious
price	precious	mystery	mysterious
pity	piteous	adventure	adventurous
miracle	miraculous	merit	meritorious
ridicule	ridiculous	humour	humorous
industry	industrious	harmony	harmonious
volume	voluminous	fame	famous

9. Adjectives formed by adding '-al'

ancestor	ancestral	colony	colonial
autumn	autumnal	finance	financial
tribe	tribal	navy	naval
verb	verbal	minister	ministerial
dictator	dictatorial	classic	classical
music	musical	politics	political
type	typical	irony	ironical
zone	zonal	node	nodal

10. Adjectives formed by adding '-ar/ary'

angle	angular	table	tabular
circle	circular	muscle	muscular
moment	momentary	station	stationary

11. Adjectives formed by adding '-en'

broad	broaden	length	lengthen
wool	woollen	earth	earthen
gold	golden	short	shorten

12. Adjectives formed by adding '-ic'

artist	artistic	base	Basic
class	classic	drama	dramatic
hero	heroic	tragedy	tragic

B. NOUNS

1. Nouns formed by adding '-hood'

brother	brotherhood	parent	parenthood
father	fatherhood	child	childhood
sister	sisterhood	girl	girlhood

2. Nouns formed by adding '-ship'

champion	championship	relation	relationship
scholar	scholarship	partner	partnership
leader	leadership	friend	friendship

3. Nouns formed by adding '-dom'

free	freedom	wise	wisdom
king	kingdom	martyr	martyrdom

4. Nouns formed by adding '-ness'

good	goodness	holy	holiness
busy	business	sad	sadness
happy	happiness	foolish	foolishness

5. Nouns formed by adding '-t/th'

wide	width	broad	breadth
die	death	deep	depth
warm	warmth	grow	growth

- Q.4 The decision was *delayed* because of him.
 (a) quickened (b) released
 (c) expedited (d) triggered
- Q.5 He felt deeply soothed by the *monotony* of his daily routine.
 (a) peacefulness (b) variety
 (c) excitement (d) tang
- Q.6 We were curious as to why the young man was looking so *gloomy*.
 (a) healthy (b) morose
 (c) haggard (d) cheerful
- Q.7 He returned home much *inspired*, no wonder their plan had worked.
 (a) overwhelmed (b) dispirited
 (c) disillusioned (d) sceptical
- Q.8 His clothes *conceal* more than is fashionable these days.
 (a) reveal (b) suggest
 (c) project (d) highlight
- Q.9 The column of soldiers *advanced* steadily under cover of fire, much against odds.
 (a) progressed (b) retarded
 (c) regressed (d) retreated
- Q.10 It was a mystery as to where from the young girl had acquired such a *cynical* attitude.
 (a) mature (b) eccentric
 (c) timid (d) crazy

Solution

Q-1	Q-2	Q-3	Q-4	Q-5	Q-6	Q-7	Q-8	Q-9	Q-10
b	b	a	c	b	d	b	a	d	c

Formation of Adjectives, Nouns and Verbs**A. ADJECTIVES****1. Adjectives formed by adding '-y'**

air	airy	hair	hairy
ice	icy	fog	foggy
fire	fiery	heart	hearty
fuss	fussy	salt	salty
anger	angry	cloud	cloudy
grass	grassy	sun	sunny
bulk	bulky	star	starry
mist	misty	fun	funny
mud	muddy	storm	stormy

2. Adjectives formed by adding '-ly'

week	weekly	neighbour	neighbourly
month	monthly	father	fatherly
hour	hourly	friend	friendly
scholar	scholarly	elder	elderly

3. Adjectives formed by adding '-ish'

girl	girlish	sheep	sheepish
devil	devilish	fool	foolish
self	selfish	slave	slavish
snob	snobbish	child	childish

4. Adjectives formed by adding '-like'

god	godlike	war	warlike
lady	ladylike	child	childlike
moon	moonlike	brother	brotherlike

5. Adjectives formed by adding '-some'

hand	handsome	tire	tiresome
trouble	troublesome	quarrel	quarrelsome
whole	wholesome	weary	wearisome

Q.10 Nothing has been organized properly and confusion seems *inevitable*.

- (a) inevident (b) inefficient
(c) ineligible (d) certain

Solution

Q-1 Q-2 Q-3 Q-4 Q-5 Q-6 Q-7 Q-8 Q-9 Q-10
a a b b b c c c d

Exercise 6

Find out the antonym for the italicized word from the options given below:

- Q.1 It was a *voluntary* gesture.
(a) valuable (b) violent
(c) compulsory (d) deliberate
- Q.2 He was the most *eccentric* and difficult patron.
(a) sociable (b) genial
(c) sober (d) normal
- Q.3 The revised pay scale is *uniform*.
(a) equal (b) opposite
(c) varied (d) different
- Q.4 He is quite *industrious*.
(a) indisposed (b) hard working
(c) indifferent (d) lazy
- Q.5 Thousands of people died of *spurious* liquor in Baroda this year.
(a) diluted (b) genuine
(c) poisonous (d) illicit
- Q.6 He tried to *conceal* the secret that they were all married.
(a) announce (b) reveal
(c) declare (d) state

Q.7 She is *slender* in figure.

- (a) slim (b) stout
(c) well-built (d) strong

Q.8 Sherlock Holmes is a *fictitious* character.

- (a) foreign (b) imaginative
(c) fancy (d) real

Q.9 She *detests* government jobs.

- (a) adores (b) approves of
(c) is fond of (d) is interested in

Q.10 Have you seen that *timid* child?

- (a) tender (b) tall
(c) brave (d) big

Solution

Q-1 Q-2 Q-3 Q-4 Q-5 Q-6 Q-7 Q-8 Q-9 Q-10
c d d d b b b d b c

Exercise 7

Find out the antonym for the italicized word from the options given below:

- Q.1 I took a *durable* pair of shoes when I went on the march.
(a) worn out (b) fragile
(c) light (d) delicate
- Q.2 The towns-people were very surprised by the visitor's *smooth* manner.
(a) hard (b) rough
(c) tough (d) gruff
- Q.3 The refreshment we received at the end of a day's hard work was decidedly *frugal*.
(a) lavish (b) tasty
(c) liberal (d) limited

- Q.4 Their meeting was very *noisy*.
 (a) boisterous (b) quiet
 (c) calm (d) businesslike
- Q.5 She has suspended her secretary on a *flimsy* ground.
 (a) sound (b) vigorous
 (c) salutary (d) strong
- Q.6 If you read the drama carefully, you will realize that his character is *flawless*.
 (a) flawed (b) blemished
 (c) defective (d) deformed
- Q.7 After the game all the players felt *dejected*.
 (a) mournful (b) melancholy
 (c) distressed (d) elated
- Q.8 At least some students are in the habit of doing their exercises in a *clumsy* manner.
 (a) neat (b) proper
 (c) decent (d) *slovenly*
- Q.9 The treatment has *aggravated* the ailment of my brother.
 (a) eased (b) checked
 (c) restrained (d) alleviated
- Q.10 The influence of political broadcasts on election is *considerable*.
 (a) negligible (b) inadequate
 (c) insignificant (d) unimportant

Solution

Q-1	Q-2	Q-3	Q-4	Q-5	Q-6	Q-7	Q-8	Q-9	Q-10
d	a	d	b	a	b	d	a	d	a

Exercise 5

Find out the antonym for the italicized word from the given options:

- Q.1 It was universally characterized as a *progressive* measure.
 (a) regressive (b) obstructive
 (c) retrograde (d) abhorrent
- Q.2 There was no *altruistic* motive that prompted him to help her.
 (a) selfish (b) inhuman
 (c) brutal (d) wicked
- Q.3 We had a *mouth watering* meal yesterday.
 (a) heavy (b) unsavoury
 (c) tasty (d) nice
- Q.4 She was *unsure* about the safety of the new drug.
 (a) doubtful (b) certain
 (c) hopeful (d) sanguine
- Q.5 His *extravagant* habits are known to all his friends.
 (a) plentiful (b) miserly
 (c) luxuriant (d) ample
- Q.6 They took note of the *humility* of the visiting dignitary.
 (a) grandeur (b) arrogance
 (c) friendliness (d) decency
- Q.7 His friends liked everything about him except his *stubbornness*.
 (a) punctuality (b) shabbiness
 (c) flexibility (d) short-temper
- Q.8 He has a *sulky* nature.
 (a) kind (b) loving
 (c) cheerful (d) mild
- Q.9 He is well known for coming up with *impracticable* solutions.
 (a) easy (b) possible
 (c) feasible (d) alternate

Q.9 *Rear*

- (a) forward (b) forehead
(c) foreground (d) front

Q.10 *Native*

- (a) foreigner (b) newcomer
(c) stranger (d) alone

Solution

Q-1	Q-2	Q-3	Q-4	Q-5	Q-6	Q-7	Q-8	Q-9	Q-10
d	d	b	a	c	b	c	b	d	a

Exercise 3

Find out the antonym for the italicized word from the options given below:

Q.1 *Coarse*

- (a) neat (b) fine
(c) beautiful (d) simple

Q.2 *Sensuously*

- (a) lavishly (b) flippantly
(c) carelessly (d) dispassionately

Q.3 *Reckless*

- (a) wild (b) considerable
(c) casual (d) cautious

Q.4 *Nominal*

- (a) large (b) exorbitant
(c) minimal (d) costly

Q.5 *Indigenous*

- (a) strange (b) native
(c) unlawful (d) alien

Q.6 *Retard*

- (a) hinder (b) disturb
(c) hasten (d) facilitate

Q.7 *Concrete*

- (a) imperfect (b) inexact
(c) incorrect (d) abstract

Q.8 *indigent*

- (a) rich (b) splendid
(c) weak (d) poor

Q.9 *enthusiasm*

- (a) zeal (b) zest
(c) fervour (d) apathy

Q.10 *Vertical*

- (a) straight (b) horizontal
(c) slanting (d) oblique

Solution

Q-1	Q-2	Q-3	Q-4	Q-5	Q-6	Q-7	Q-8	Q-9	Q-10
b	c	d	b	b	c	d	a	d	b

Exercise 4

Find out the antonym for the italicized word from the options given below:

Q.1 The last show of the concert at Red Fort was a *flop*.

- (a) triumph (b) victory
(c) fruitful (d) success

Q.2 The members of the opposition party made *insulting* remarks about the P.M.

- (a) praiseworthy (b) respectable
(c) laudatory (d) admirable

Q.3 His writings have been *rejected* by Indian scholars.

- (a) condemned (b) flouted
(c) disapproved (d) appreciated

- Q.2 *Adversity* is the source of numerous vices.
 (a) wealth (b) prosperity
 (c) luxury (d) money
- Q.3 His *repulsive* behaviour could not be ignored by the members of the jury.
 (a) lovely (b) mild
 (c) admirable (d) attractive
- Q.4 He is an *amateur* photographer.
 (a) average (b) experienced
 (c) professional (d) skilled
- Q.5 The witness *confessed* on oath that he was an eyewitness to the crime under study.
 (a) contradicted (b) opposed
 (c) disputed (d) denied
- Q.6 On the hillside, he could see the *vague* shapes of sheep coming through the mist.
 (a) clear (b) transparent
 (c) plain (d) apparent
- Q.7 His *casual* remarks were taken note of by all members of the board.
 (a) careful (b) sincere
 (c) precise (d) flawless
- Q.8 If you *pamper* the child you will regret it later.
 (a) scold (b) scorn
 (c) discourage (d) neglect
- Q.9 These rules are meant to *prevent* further appointments.
 (a) allow (b) accelerate
 (c) expedite (d) aggravate
- Q.10 The artist led a very *austere* life.
 (a) luxurious (b) boisterous
 (c) exciting (d) eventful

Solution

Q-1	Q-2	Q-3	Q-4	Q-5	Q-6	Q-7	Q-8	Q-9	Q-10
d	b	d	c	d	a	a	d	a	a

Exercise 2

Find out the antonym for the italicized word from the options given below:

- Q.1 *Lenient*
 (a) fickle (b) lazy
 (c) insipid (d) strict
- Q.2 *Merciless*
 (a) obscure (b) injurious
 (c) urgently (d) compassionate
- Q.3 *Scandalise*
 (a) speak of (b) praise
 (c) denigrate (d) befriend
- Q.4 *Bleak*
 (a) bright (b) open
 (c) discouraging (d) sound
- Q.5 *Pessimist*
 (a) theist (b) believer
 (c) optimist (d) vocalist
- Q.6 *Meagre*
 (a) excessive (b) plentiful
 (c) extravagant (d) average
- Q.7 *Leap*
 (a) immerse (b) fall
 (c) sink (d) plunge
- Q.8 *Smooth*
 (a) hard (b) rough
 (c) awkward (d) ugly

Word	Antonym	Word	Antonym
refuse	allow	resolve	hesitate
relevance	irrelevance	retreat	advance
remember	forget	right	wrong
repulsive	attractive	ripe	raw
resign	adhere	rise	fall
resist	submit	rising	setting
S			
sacred	profane	simple	complex
safe	unsafe	sink	swim
saint	sinner	slim	fat
savage	civilized	slow	quick
seclusion	company	sour	sweet
secondary	primary	spontaneous	deliberate
senior	junior	stability	instability
sensible	insensible	stable	unstable
separate	unite	stout	lean, thin
severe	gentle	strange	familiar
short	long	strict	lax
shorten	lengthen	strong	weak
shut	open	superior	inferior
sick	healthy	sweet	bitter, sour
T			
take	give	top	bottom
tame	wild	total	part
teach	learn	tough	easy
temporary	permanent	tragic	comic
terminate	begin	transparent	opaque
thin	thick	trust	doubt
U			
unanimity	dissent	up	down
uniformity	variety	useful	useless
unify	diversify	usual	unusual

Word	Antonym	Word	Antonym
V			
vacant	occupied	veteran	novice
vague	definite	vice	virtue
valiant	cowardly	vigilant	careless
verbal	written	vital	superficial
vertical	horizontal	vulgar	refined
W			
wake	sleep	wicked	virtuous
warm	cool	widen	narrow
waste	reclaim	wild	tame
wed	divorce	win	lose
well	unwell	wise	stupid
wet	dry	woo	avoid
Y			
yell	whisper	young	old
yield	resist	yours	mine
Z			
zealous	listless	zest	lukewarm
zenith	nadir	zigzag	straight

Solved Examples

Exercise 1

Find out the antonym for the italicized word from the options given below:

- Q.1 The new boss is well known for his *rigid* approach to all problems.
- (a) swift (b) logical
(c) sympathetic (d) flexible

Word	Antonym	Word	Antonym
------	---------	------	---------

J

jitters	calm, cool	joy	sorrow
join	leave	junior	senior

K

keen	dull	knowledge	ignorance
kind	cruel	known	unknown

L

lament	rejoice	lessen	extend
large	small	liberal	conservative
lass	lad	life	death
latent	apparent	light	darkness, heavy
laud	condemn	like	dislike, unlike
laugh	weep	live	die
launch	withdraw	live	recorded
lavish	economical	local	universal
lead	follow	long	short
left	right	loose	tight
legitimate	illegitimate	lose	win
lenient	strict	loud	low

M

mad	sane	material	spiritual
magnify	reduce	mental	physical
malady	remedy	merger	split
male	female	merit	demerit
mar	make	mild	harsh
married	bachelor, virgin	minor	major
masculine	feminine	mortal	immortal
master	slave, servant	motion	rest

Word	Antonym
------	---------

narrow	broad
nasty	pleasant
native	foreign
natural	artificial
neat	clumsy
negligent	careful

objective	subjective
oblique	straight
odd	even
old	young
opaque	transparent

pain	pleasure
particular	general
peace	war
perilous	safe
perish	flourish
permanent	temporary
persuade	dissuade
plain	obscure

queer	normal
question	answer
quick	slow

real	false
reality	illusion
rear	front
receive	give

Word	Antonym	Word	Antonym
confess	deny	country	town
conquest	defeat	courteous	rude
constant	fickle	create	destroy
construct	demolish	credit	debit
contract	expand	creditor	debtor
convex	concave	cruel	kind
cool	warm	curse	blessing

D

danger	safety	depreciate	appreciate
dangerous	safe	deprive	provide
daring	timid	different	similar
dark	light	difficult	easy
dead	alive	diligent	lazy
decrease	increase	disease	health
decrease	increase	docile	stubborn
deep	shallow	dogmatic	liberal
defensive	offensive	domestic	wild
deficit	surplus	doubt	faith
delay	expedite	doubtful	sure
demand	supply	dwarf	giant

E

early	late	enthusiasm	indifference
elevation	depression	entrance	exit
empty	full	ever	never
encouraging	discouraging	exclude	include
end	beginning	explicit	implicit
enmity	friendship	extravagant	economical, frugal

F

fact	fiction	faith	doubt
fail	succeed	false	true
failure	success	falsehood	truth
fair	fool	famous	obscure

Word	Antonym	Word	Antonym
far	near	freedom	slavery
find	miss	freeze	melt
fit	unfit	friend	foe, enemy
foreign	native	full	empty

G

-gain	loss	grand	simple
generous	selfish, mean	grant	refuse
giant	dwarf	great	small
glad	sad	guest	host
glory	shame	guilty	innocent

H

haphazard	systematic	help	hinder
happiness	misery	high	low
happy	miserable	homogeneous	heterogeneous
hard	soft	honest	dishonest
hate	love	honour	shame
haughty	humble	hope	despair
head	tail	horizontal	vertical
health	illness	hostile	congenial
heaven	hell	humble	proud
heavy	light	hurt	heal

I

idle	busy	individually	collectively
ignorance	knowledge	indolence	diligence
illicit	lawful	inferior	superior
import	export	inhale	exhale
important	trivial	initiate	finalise
impulsively	deliberately	install	remove
include	exclude	intelligent	dull
increase	decrease	invest	divest

- Q.7 The principal's advice will prove *salutary* for the students.
 (a) harmful (b) beneficial
 (c) remarkable (d) encouraging
- Q.8 The speech he made on the occasion was quite *exhilarating*.
 (a) learned (b) lively
 (c) boring (d) irrelevant
- Q.9 We led an *austere* life in the mountain.
 (a) religious (b) lacking
 (c) unsteady (d) harsh
- Q.10 Some people adopt excellent manners only to *camouflage* their real character.
 (a) reveal (b) misrepresent
 (c) hide (d) project

Solution

Q-1	Q-2	Q-3	Q-4	Q-5	Q-6	Q-7	Q-8	Q-9	Q-10
a	b	b	c	d	c	b	b	b	c

Antonyms

Antonym is a word which is opposite in meaning/sense.

If words exactly opposite in meaning are not available, we select the words nearest opposite in sense.

A antonym has to perform the same function in a sentence as the original word does. Thus a noun must have a noun antonym; an adjective must be replaced by an adjective antonym, and so on.

Word	Antonym	Word	Antonym
A			
above	below	all	none
absent	present	analysis	synthesis
abundance	scarcity, dearth	ancestor	descendant
accelerate	retard	ancient	modern
accept	refuse, reject	angel	devil
acknowledge	deny	angry	pleased
active	passive	arrival	departure
acute	obtuse	ascent	descent
add	subtract	assent	dissent
adversity	prosperity	attack	defence
affirm	deny	attraction	repulsion
agree	differ, disagree	authentic	spurious
B			
back	front	bold	timid
barbarous	civilized	borrow	lend
base	noble	brave	coward
beautiful	ugly	bravery	cowardice
beauty	ugliness	break	make
beginning	end	bright	dull
benefit	loss	broad	narrow
birth	death	bullish	bearish
bitter	sweet	bunch	apart, separate
blunt	sharp	buy	sell
C			
care	neglect	clever	stupid
careful	careless	cloudy	clear
ceaseless	intermittent	coarse	fine
celestial	terrestrial	comfort	distress
certain	doubtful	compare	contrast
cheat	honest	competent	incompetent
cheerful	gloomy	complex	simple
civility	rudeness	conceal	reveal
clean	dirty	concord	discord

- (a) dangerous (b) impracticable
(c) obscure (d) irrational
- Q.3 Sunlight and shadow made the landscape a *kaleidoscope* of colour.
(a) tube containing mirrors and loose pieces of coloured glass
(b) frequently changing pattern of bright scenes
(c) a mixture of black and white
(d) resembling the seven colours of a rainbow
- Q.4 A person unrestrained by the rules of morality or tradition is called a *licentious* person.
(a) libertine (b) loafer-type
(c) criminal (d) freelance
- Q.5 I wrote to him as *lately* as last week.
(a) immediately (b) early
(c) recently (d) late
- Q.6 When he returned he was accompanied by a *sprightly* young girl.
(a) beautiful (b) lively
(c) intelligent (d) sportive
- Q.7 The recent acts of *vandalism* in the country cannot be ignored.
(a) disturbance (b) ravage
(c) provocation (d) violence
- Q.8 She has an *insatiable* love for music.
(a) unsatisfiable (b) unchanging
(c) irreconcilable (d) undesirable
- Q.9 The international community may begin to doubt the *credentials* of the largest democracy in the world.
(a) principles (b) dependability
(c) capacity to return loans (d) trustworthiness

- Q.10 The *indiscriminate* demand for mass consumption goods is deplorable.
(a) desperate (b) undifferentiated
(c) discreet (d) random

Solution

Q-1	Q-2	Q-3	Q-4	Q-5	Q-6	Q-7	Q-8	Q-9	Q-10
a	c	a	a	c	b	b	a	d	d

Exercise 5

Find out the synonym for italicized word from the options given below:

- Q.1 *Courtesy* does not cost one anything.
(a) urbanity (b) amiability
(c) civility (d) gentility
- Q.2 It is *hazardous* to give up one's job before another is found.
(a) adventurous (b) risky
(c) stupid (d) inadvisable
- Q.3 He could not suppress his *resentment* against that decision.
(a) excitement (b) displeasure
(c) irritation (d) indignation
- Q.4 His speech was full of *affectation*.
(a) euphemism (b) dependency
(c) pretence (d) boasting
- Q.5 The *affluence* of most visiting Arabs is astonishing.
(a) influence (b) distention
(c) endeavour (d) wealth
- Q.6 This group is quite *heterogeneous* some are very rich while some are very poor.
(a) callusing (b) sudden
(c) varied (d) conciliatory

- (a) perpetuate (b) engender
(c) embalm (d) perpetrate
- Q.10 The king declared that his *decision* was *final and unalterable*.
(a) decisive (b) conclusive
(c) irrevocable (d) irredeemable

Solution

Q-1 Q-2 Q-3 Q-4 Q-5 Q-6 Q-7 Q-8 Q-9 Q-10
d c c c a d a b a c

Exercise 3

Find out the synonym for italicized word/words from the options given below:

- Q.1 He is a *likely* candidate to win the contest.
(a) Popular (b) likeable
(c) probable (d) usual
- Q.2 In spite of their best efforts, the Kashmir problem continues to be *contentious* issue between India and Pakistan.
(a) friendly (b) likely to cause argument
(c) ill-tempered (d) hasty
- Q.3 She was the first woman to enter Parliament and when she made her *first speech* the house gave her a loud applause.
(a) feminine (b) beautiful
(c) excellent (d) maiden
- Q.4 Czechoslovakia is a *fascinating* country.
(a) large (b) charming
(c) foreign (d) communist
- Q.5 I would not doubt his *integrity* for one moment.
(a) unity (b) honesty
(c) faith (d) courage

- Q.6 The culprit was given *rigorous* punishment.
(a) powerful (b) severe
(c) strong (d) violent
- Q.7 His application was given *precedence in rank* by the committee because he was an outstanding sportsman.
(a) priority (b) necessity
(c) urgency (d) attention
- Q.8 Our army is *invincible*.
(a) strong (b) unconquerable
(c) powerful (d) excellent
- Q.9 It was a *hazardous* journey.
(a) haphazard (b) dangerous
(c) horrible (d) tiresome
- Q.10 With the final exams close at hand, no student can afford to be *complacent* about his studies.
(a) self-satisfied (b) pessimistic
(c) ecstatic (d) tolerable

Solution

Q-1 Q-2 Q-3 Q-4 Q-5 Q-6 Q-7 Q-8 Q-9 Q-10
c b d b b b a b b a

Exercise 4

Find out the synonym for italicized word from the options given below:

- Q.1 Lack of occupation is not necessarily revealed by *manifest* idleness.
(a) easily perceived (b) easily acquired
(c) easily infected (d) easily deflected
- Q.2 Even today many people are guided by *abstruse* moral values.

- Q.6 As she had never been in such a terrible situation before, her *apprehension* was understandable.
 (a) eagerness (b) fear
 (c) hesitation (d) excitement
- Q.7 You should not get *disturbed by* what others think of you.
 (a) flattered by (b) influenced
 (c) obsessed with (d) upset by
- Q.8 I wonder if *mediation* in the dispute will be of any help.
 (a) interception (b) interruption
 (c) intervention (d) meddling
- Q.9 A strange mental *disorder* often made her forget her own name.
 (a) eccentricity (b) insanity
 (c) aberration (d) illusion
- Q.10 He treats with *anger* any one who goes to him for help.
 (a) Annoyance (b) disgust
 (c) insolence (d) displeasure

Solution

- | | | | | | | | | | |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|------|
| Q-1 | Q-2 | Q-3 | Q-4 | Q-5 | Q-6 | Q-7 | Q-8 | Q-9 | Q-10 |
| b | b | a | b | d | b | d | c | c | a |

Exercise 2

Find out the synonym for the italicized portion from the options given below:

- Q.1 As the speaker *wandered in his talk and did not keep to the subject*, the audience grew impatient.
 (a) deviated (b) wandered
 (c) swerved (d) diaggessed
- Q.2 His *theatrical manner* made even his sincere statements sound unconvincing.

- (a) play-acting (b) dramaturgy
 (c) histrionics (d) actions
- Q.3 The *unbearable* behaviour of the servant made him lose his job whenever he got one.
 (a) indecent (b) impatient
 (c) intolerable (d) insulting
- Q.4 The civic authorities were at their wits end when, despite their best efforts, cholera *spread unchecked and was beyond control* among the citizens.
 (a) endemic (b) spreading
 (c) epidemic (d) rampant
- Q.5 The flood of *personal experience and first hand record of events* written by the retired military general, who had seen much action during war, became the best-seller in the late forties.
 (a) memoirs (b) reminiscences
 (c) autobiography (d) reports
- Q.6 The *total freedom from care* enjoyed by the rich man's son made him unfit for any serious work.
 (a) careworn state (b) not worried
 (c) carelessness (d) complacency
- Q.7 I could immediately identify you because your face *reminds me* of your mother's.
 (a) resembles (b) is a replica of
 (c) is duplicate of (d) is a prototype of
- Q.8 The clever inspector understood the whole game when the accused *tried to evade telling the whole truth*.
 (a) pretend (b) prevaricate
 (c) lie (d) deceive
- Q.9 The best way we can *preserve from being forgotten the memory* of a great man is to follow his ideals, not merely erect a statue for him.

Word	Synonym	Word	Synonym
U			
ultimate	final	unity	oneness
umpire	referee	uphold	maintain
unanimity	accord	urbane	civilized
understand	follow	usage	practice
uniform	regular	useful	advantageous
union	association	usual	ordinary
unique	matchless	usurp	snatch
unite	join	utter	speak
V			
vacant	empty	verdict	judgement
vaccinate	inoculate	verge	edge, limit
vague	indistinct	veteran	experienced
valiant	brave	via	through
value	worth	villain	rascal
vanish	disappear	virgin	maiden
vast	big	virile	manly
vengeance	revenge	virtuous	chaste
venture	undertaking	virtuous	upright
veranda	porch	vocation	occupation
verbose	wordy	voluntarily	willingly
W			
war	conflict	wide	broad
warn	caution	wild	untamed
waver	hesitate	wisdom	learning
weak	feeble	wise	intelligent
wealthy	rich	work	business
weary	tired	world	earth
wet	damp	wrath	anger
wicked	sinful	wrong	incorrect
Y			
yankee	American	yearn	long
yarn	thread	yeasty	frothy

Word	Synonym	Word	Synonym
yell	scream	young	youthful
yield	submit	yummy	delicious
Z			
zeal	eagerness	zone	area
zest	enthusiasm	zoom	move

Solved Examples

Exercise 1

Find out the synonym for the italicized word from the options given below:

- Q.1 He spoke *instantly* on the occasion.
 (a) eloquently (b) impromptu
 (c) without enthusiasm (d) with great force
- Q.2 The *constant* noise made it impossible for them to concentrate on the problems.
 (a) irritating (b) perpetual
 (c) unlimited (d) recurrent
- Q.3 In spite of his best efforts the officer could not *redeem* his prestige.
 (a) recover (b) raise
 (c) extend (d) fulfil
- Q.4 There is *abundant* supply of water for the crop.
 (a) considerable (b) plentiful
 (c) adequate (d) sufficient
- Q.5 All his attempts to win the favour of his boss proved *futile*.
 (a) meaningless (b) unnecessary
 (c) redundant (d) fruitless

Word	Synonym	Word	Synonym
perfume	scent	previous	former
period	time, era	price	cost
persuade	convince	pride	haughtiness
please	delight	prime	main
polite	courteous	primitive	ancient
polite	refined	principal	chief
pollute	defile	prior	previous
potency	power	probable	likely
poverty	want	probable	likely
power	strength	proclaim	declare
precarious	unstable, <u>uncertain</u>	product	outcome
		profit	gain
precise	exact	prohibit	forbid
predict	foretell	prolong	extend
prejudice	bias	prominent	leading
preserve	save	prompt	timely, swift
prestige	respect	proper	suitable
pretend	feign	protect	defend
pretty	fair	proud	haughty
prevent	check	punch	hit

Q

quantity	amount	quiet	calm
quarrel (n)	dispute	quit	give-up, leave
quest	search	quiz	ask

R

rapid	fast	redeem	recover
rapture	ecstasy	refuge	shelter
rash	reckless	relish	enjoy
rational	logical	remarkable	extraordinary
real	genuine	renounce	give up
recognize	identify	reply	answer
recollect	recall	repress	suppress
recreation	amusement	resentment	anger
rectify	correct	reside	dwell

Word	Synonym	Word	Synonym
respect	esteem	rich	wealthy
retain	keep	rival	adversary

S

sad	gloomy	smooth	even
say	speak	speed	velocity
scene	view, panorama	spurious	false
scent	smell	stable	firm
sceptic	non-believer	steep	sharp
see	look	strength	power
seem	appear	stretch	extend
separate	divide	stupid	dull
serene	calm	sublime	exalted
shade (n)	cover	substitute	replace
shake	tremble	sufficient	adequate
shame	disgrace	suffocate	choke
shape	form	suitable	fitting
sharp	intelligent	surplus	excess
significant	important	suspicion	mistrust
simple	plain	synopsis	summary
singular	unique	system	method

T

talents	ability	tidy	clean
tame	subdue	tired	weary
target	goal	topic	subject
tarnish	spoil	total	whole
task	work	trade	commerce, business
teach	educate		
tell	describe	transpire	turn out, emerge
tender	delicate	trifling	trivial
territory	area	triumph	victory
thick	dense	truth	veracity
think	reflect	twinkle	blink
thrive	prosper	<u>tyrannical</u>	<u>despotic</u>

Word	Synonym	Word	Synonym
incomparable	matchless	insolence	arrogance
inconstant	changeable	insomnia	sleeplessness
industrious	diligent	intention	purpose
inference	deduction	interrupt	stop
infinite	limitless	invisible	hidden
influence	induce	ironic	satirical
J			
jealous	envious	judgement	verdict, opinion
join	unite	junk	useless
joke	jest	just	fair
joy	happiness	juvenile	childish
K			
kidnap	abduct	king-size	large
kill	murder	know	comprehend
kind	generous	knowledge	learning
L			
lasting	permanent	listen	hear
latent	hidden	little	small
laudable	praiseworthy	live	reside
laugh	ridicule	lofty	high
lawful	permissible	logical	reasonable
leave (n)	permission	lonely	lonesome
leave (v)	quit	love	affection
let	allow	lovely	beautiful
liberal	generous	low	aloof
M			
madness	insanity	maxim	saying
magnificent	grand	maximum	most
malady	ailment	mediocre	average
management	organisation	meditate	contemplate
marriage	wedding	memory	recollection

Word	Synonym	Word	Synonym
mend	repair	modest	shy
method	system	moody	unpredictable
mingle	mix	motionless	still
minimum	least	motive	intention
minute	small	mourn	lament
misfortune	calamity	murmur	mutter
mistake	error	mysterious	unknown
N			
neat	clean	noble	great
necessary	essential	note	observe
new	fresh	novel	new
news	information	novice	beginner
nice	fine	nude	naked
O			
object (v)	oppose	opportunity	occasion
obsolete	outdated	oppose	resist
obstacle	hurdle	opt	choose
obstinate	hindrance	oral	verbal
obvious	headstrong	ordinary	common
occasion	clear	origin	source
odd	chance, event	oust	expel
odour	strange	ovation	applause
offend	smell	over	finished
old	displease	overlook	condone
opinion	ancient	over-see	supervise
	view	own	possess
P			
pain	agony	pattern	design
pardon	forgive	peace	harmony
parity	correspondence	penalty	punishment
	similarity	perceive	comprehend
patience	perseverance	perfect	faultless

Word	Synonym	Word	Synonym
darling	dear	D	
debate	argue	die	expire
deceive	cheat	difficult	hard
decent	respectful	dirty	shabby
decision	resolution	disaster	calamity
declaration	announcement	discord	conflict
decrease	reduce	discover	find, reveal
defence	protection	discriminate	distinguish
deficient	lacking	disease	illness
definite	exact	distant	far off
demise	death	distinct	clear
desire	wish	distinguished	eminent
despise	condemn, scorn	divulge	disclose
destroy	demolish	donation	gift
determination	firmness	doubt	suspicious
detrimental	harmful	drowsy	sleepy
		dull	stupid
		dunce	stupid
		E	
eager	keen	esteem	honour, regard
elegant	polished	eternal	everlasting
eminent	famous	event	incident
encourage	cheer, hearten	evidence	proof
end	finish	exact	precise
endeavour	attempt	excuse	pardon
endless	infinite	explicit	clear
enmity	hostility	extempore	unprepared
enormous	huge	extra	surplus
enough	plenty, sufficient	extraordinary	unusual, remarkable
enquire	ask	extravagant	wasteful
entertain	please, amuse	exultation	joy
error	mistake	F	
		fade	wither
face	countenance, look	faithfulness	loyalty

Word	Synonym	Word	Synonym
false	untrue	force	compel
fame	reputation	foresight	forethought
famous	reputed	form	shape
fat	stout, bulky	fortitude	courage
fault	defect	fortune	luck
favour	help, support	frail	weak
	flexible elastic	frigid	cold
foolish	stupid	futile	useless
		G	
gain	advantage	govern	rule
gap	breach, fissure	grand	magnificent
generous	liberal	grant	sanction, allow
genial	cordial	grave	serious
genius	talent	greedy	avaricious
gentle	kind	grief	sorrow
give	impart	grill	interrogate
glad	happy	guard	watchman
		H	
habit	custom	honesty	uprightness
happiness	delight	hope	expect
hardly	scarcely	hopeful	optimistic
haste	hurry	horrible	terrible
hate	despise	hostile	aggressive, unfriendly
haughty	proud	house	residence
hidden	secret	huge	immense
hollow	empty	humane	kind
holy	sacred	I	
idle	lazy	immediately	at once
ignorant	uneducated	impetuous	hasty
ignore	disregard	implore	pray, request
ill	sick, unwell	imposture	pretence, masquerade
imagination	fancy	incident	happening
immaculate	spotless		

is nearly so.

A synonym is not an exact substitute of a word; not similar in meaning but almost similar in sense.

A synonym has to perform the same function in a sentence as the original word does. Thus a noun must have a noun synonym; an adjective must be replaced by an adjective synonym, and so on.

Illustration

I praise her form. (verb)

I admire her form. (verb)

This is exactly what he meant. (adv.)

This is precisely what he meant. (adv.)

Word	Synonym	Word	Synonym
A			
abandon	forsake, desert	allow	permit
ability	skill, capacity	alter	change
abnormal	unusual, uncommon	ambition	aim, aspiration
abrupt	sudden	amiable	gentle, pleasing
absorbed	engrossed	amuse	entertain
accommodate	adjust	announce	declare
accomplish	complete, achieve	antique	ancient
accord	agreement	applicable	suitable
accuse	charge	arrogant	haughty
acknowledge	admit, accept	assembly	gathering
active	industrious	assistance	help
admire	applaud, praise	attack	confront
admit	confess	attain	achieve
advantage	gain, benefit	attentive	alert
advice	counsel	auspicious	favourable
affluent	wealthy	avarice	greed
aftermath	consequence	average	ordinary
agile	quick	aversion	dislike, hatred
		avert	prevent

Semantics

Word	Synonym
bad	evil
barbarous	uncivilized
baseless	groundless
bear	tolerate
beat	hit, knock
beautiful	good looking
behaviour	conduct
belief	faith
bewitching	charming
calamity	disaster, misfortune
calm	peaceful, quiet
care	attention
careless	reckless, indifferent
caution	warning
cautious	careful
celebrated	famous
celestial	heavenly
ceremony	function
certain	sure
chance	possibility
chaos	disorder
character	conduct, nature
chaste	pure
childish	silly
choice	selection
circular	round
civil	polite
civilization	refinement
classify	arrange

Suffix

-able	eatable, tolerable, memorable
-age	bondage, pilgrimage, personage
-al	mechanical, electrical, refusal, cultural
-ance	governance, annoyance, arrogance
-ant	militant, consultant, resultant
-ate	motivate, translate, congratulate
-ation	reservation, cancellation, equalisation
-cracy	bureaucracy, aristocracy
-ed	aimed, gheraoed, drained
-ee	addressee, payee, refugee
-ence	reverence, negligence, excellence
-er	remover, joker, cricketer, swimmer, speaker, dreamer
-eer	profiteer, engineer, volunteer, auctioneer
-en	shorten, lengthen, harden
-ess	tigress, happiness, poetess
-ful	joyful, handful, grateful, graceful, colourful, tearful
-hood	neighbourhood, sisterhood
-ible	negligible, sensible
-ic	poetic, scenic, heroic, dogmatic
-ify	rectify, beautify, qualify
-ing	levelling, counselling, modelling
-ion	action, situation, solution
-ish	boyish, modish, feverish,
-ism	idealism, conservatism, scepticism, animalism
-ist	socialist, leftist, moralist, separatist
-ity	superiority, totality, solidity, vitality
-ive	creative, preservative,
-ize	minimize, dehumanize, commercialize
-less	luckless, faithless, homeless
-like	godlike, businesslike, childlike
-ly	safely, quickly, dearly, manly, relatively, motherly
-ment	allotment, appointment, engagement
-ness	kindness, goodness, fitness, illness
-or	protector, inspector, defector

Semantics

-ous	glorious, virtuous, dangerous, religious
-ry	machinery, jewellery, gentry
-ship	hardship, friendship, scholarship
-th	growth, warmth
-wise	clockwise, worldly-wise, otherwise, name-wise
-worthy	praiseworthy, roadworthy, trustworthy

Unsolved Exercise

Note the use of *suffixes* 'ist' and 'ian' in the following examples:
 A person who studies and applies science is a *scientist*.
 A person who studies phonetics is a *phonetician*.

Now, fill in the blanks in the following:

- A person who studies and applies technology is a
- A person who studies and applies geology is a
- A person who studies and applies biology is a
- A person who studies and applies chemistry is a
- A person who studies and applies psychology is a
- A person who studies and applies mathematics is a
- A person who studies and applies statistics is a
- A person who studies and applies theology is a
- A person who studies and applies electricity is an
- One who practices radiology is a
- One who practices magic is a
- One who makes cartoons is a

Synonyms

In written as well as in oral communication repeating one word several times in a short span of time and space is not pleasing. We look for variety. So, we need *substitute words that are similar in meaning*. These words are called *synonyms*.

In practice, words similar in meaning do not exist. A synonym of a word, therefore, is not an exact equivalent of the original – it

Communication Skills (Handout)

Semantics

cation. So one must add up to one's existing stock of words. It can be done by reading more and by mastering the art of making new words.

However, it has to be kept in mind that words acquire their meanings from the context in which they are used. For instance: a word can be employed as a noun in one sentence and used as a verb in another.

1. *Export* of sugar is banned. (noun)

We *export* sugar. (verb)

2. Hard *work* ensures good marks. (noun)

Work hard to get good marks. (verb)

Words as shown above, act differently.

For learning language, therefore, one has to understand the function of words. A word can act as a Noun, Pronoun, Adjective, Verb, Adverb, Preposition, Conjunction or Interjection.

Derivative of Words

New words are formed when a letter or group of letters are added to a primary word either in the beginning or at the end. The letter/group of letters added to the beginning of a word is called *Prefix* and that added to the end is called *Suffix*.

Prefix

anti-	anti-social, anti-septic, anti-establishment
ante-	ante-node, ante-room
be-	behead, bemoan, befriend, beloved
co-	co-operation, co-exist, co-produce, co-author
de-	decode, defrost, dehydrate, decentralization, decongest, deforestation, demerit
dis-	disorder, dislike, dislodge, disconnect, disappear, distrust, displease, disorganize

antecedent - the word preceding person or event

Antedate

Antecedent: to go before
Ante-dinner
time before the food

em-	empower, embolden, embitter
en-	endanger, enlist, enjoy, encamp
extra-	extra-curricular, extraordinary, extramarital
fore-	forecast, foretell, foresee, fore-noon
hyper-	hypersensitive, hypertension
inter-	inter-college, inter-university
il/ill	illegible, illegal, ill-gotten, ill-bred, ill-will
im-	impossible, immature, impractical, immovable, impolite
in-	indiscipline, inefficient, indirect, ineffective, inexperienced, inability
ir-	irregular, irreversible, irrational, irresponsible
mini-	mini-skirt, mini-bus, mini-bar
non-	non-violence, non-stop, non-issue, non-payment, non-sense
out-	outlet, outlive, outshine, outwit, outmoded
pre-	pre-marital, preoccupied, pre-planned, pre-recorded
pro-	pro-establishment, pro-government, pro-active
re-	recall, remix, reload, relocate
semi-	semi-final, semi-circular, semi-nude
super-	superman, superpower, supermarket
ultra-	ultra-modern, ultra-violet, ultra-sonic
un-	unnatural, undress, unhappy, unlock, unexpected, unusual, unfortunate
under-	underworld, underestimate, underused, understated
vice-	vice-president, vice-chancellor, vice-principal

Unsolved Exercise

Add a suitable *prefix* to each of the following words so as to make then convey the opposite meaning.

inclined	accompanied	closed
represent	expected	perfect
pleasure	engage	successful
resolute	violence	justified
conspicuous	harmony	carry